

Guide + fillable workbook

Before You Sign

The Athlete Family NIL Toolkit

A practical system for evaluating offers, asking informed questions, and managing brand partnerships.

Welcome

The first offer changes the conversation.

Preparation gives your family a place to begin.

A business wants to work with your athlete. Compensation comes up. An agreement arrives. A family familiar with practices, tournaments, and recruiting is suddenly discussing content rights, payment conditions, and exclusivity.

You do not need to know every business term to ask a useful question. You do need a process. This toolkit helps you organize an opportunity, identify missing information, and prepare for conversations with the people advising your family.

Keep the athlete involved.

The opportunity uses their identity, requires their time, and can affect future choices. Their understanding and preferences belong at the center of the decision.

Four terms to know

NIL

Name, image, and likeness: the athlete's identity used in a partnership.

Deliverables

The posts, appearances, or other work promised.

Usage rights

Permission to use identity or content.

Exclusivity

A restriction on other partnerships.

Record the proposed scope and ask an adviser about unclear terms.

This toolkit provides general educational guidance and is not legal advice. Consult a qualified attorney about your specific circumstances before signing an agreement. For an attorney referral, contact Dexter Sports Management.

Tax, eligibility, and immigration questions should be directed to the appropriate qualified professional. Requirements depend on the athlete and the rules that apply.

Your toolkit

A clear path through the offer

Tap a section to jump to its pages. Tap the footer on any page to return here.

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Type into the shaded fields and save a copy, or print the worksheets. A PDF reader with form support works best. Save, close, and reopen your copy to confirm entries remain. The fields are for brief notes; keep supporting documents separately.

01

Family brief

Define a worthwhile opportunity

Complete this together before evaluating the first offer.

What does the athlete want from NIL opportunities?

Which brands or categories fit their interests? Which would they decline?

How much time can the athlete commit during the season?

What personal information and family boundaries will remain private?

Who will organize offers, deadlines, and professional guidance?

What would make an otherwise attractive offer unsuitable?

Family commitment

We will review opportunities with the athlete, make room for questions, and understand the commitment before accepting.

02

Offer snapshot

Put the offer in one place

*Write “not provided” wherever information is missing.***Brand, legal contracting entity, and verified contact****Athlete or entity being asked to sign; campaign purpose****Required work, platforms, and campaign dates****Cash, products, services, and expense arrangements****Proposed usage rights, exclusivity, and agreement dates****Response deadline; missing documents and attachments****Get the whole document**

Request the complete agreement and every referenced attachment. Check that the written offer reflects what was discussed.

02 / Deliverable planner

Make the work specific

Use this page to turn a general campaign idea into a clear set of tasks.

Posts or content: format, quantity, platform, and publication dates

Appearances: location, duration, travel, and required activities

Who approves content, and how much review time is needed?

How many revisions are included? How are additional requests handled?

What production costs or equipment will be needed?

How will completion be documented?

Discuss capacity early.

Check the proposed schedule against classes, training, competition, travel, and recovery before committing.

02 / Compensation

Understand the cash picture

Record products and services separately from spendable cash.

Cash compensation and any conditions for earning it

Payment trigger, due date, and invoice requirements

Products or services offered; stated value and delivery date

Athlete-paid expenses; approved reimbursements and timing

Representative fees: rate, income covered, and payment timing

Cash planning calculation

Cash compensation

–

Athlete-paid
expenses

–

Applicable
representative fees

=

Estimated cash
remaining before
taxes

Cash compensation minus athlete-paid expenses and applicable representative fees equals estimated cash remaining before taxes. This is a planning estimate, not a tax calculation.

Our estimated cash remaining before taxes

03

Professional discussion

Questions to bring to counsel

Bring the actual agreement and attachments. Use these prompts to focus the conversation.

Topic	Question to discuss
Work and approval	Are the deliverables, revision limits, and approval standards clear?
Payment	What conditions affect payment, and what happens if approval or payment is delayed?
Cancellation	Who may end the arrangement, and what happens to completed work, expenses, and compensation?
Changes in circumstances	What happens after injury, illness, schedule changes, a transfer, or a campaign change?
Risk and responsibility	What do the waivers, liability provisions, and any personal guarantee mean for the athlete or signer?
Disputes and ongoing duties	How are disagreements handled, and what obligations continue after the arrangement ends?

Ask for a plain-language explanation.

Flag any term you cannot explain, including perpetual, irrevocable, sole discretion, indemnify, or guarantor. Ask what it means in this specific agreement.

This page organizes questions. It does not interpret a contract or determine whether a provision is appropriate.

03 / Usage rights

What permission is requested?

Record the proposed scope, then discuss unclear terms with counsel.

Content or identity covered: name, image, voice, video, or other material

Channels and territory: where may the material appear?

Organic posts, paid advertising, and advertising through athlete accounts

Editing, sharing with other businesses, and any AI or synthetic use

Permission start date, end date, and use after the agreement ends

Changes or additional compensation to discuss

Two different things

Creating a post and permitting a brand to reuse it are different parts of the opportunity. Record both.

03 / Exclusivity

Account for future choices

An opportunity may affect which other partnerships the athlete can accept.

Restricted product categories and specifically named competitors**Start date, end date, and any continuing restriction****Existing partnerships or school commitments to check****Future opportunities that could be affected****Questions for the brand, compliance office, or attorney****Clarifications or changes requested****Be specific.**

A broad category description can be difficult to evaluate. Ask which businesses and activities the proposed restriction would cover.

04

Representation

Interview the person first

Ask each candidate to explain the role, qualifications, service, and fee.

Services

What will you do, what is outside your scope, and who handles the account?

Experience

What relevant work and references can you share? What credentials apply, and where can we verify them?

Fees

What income is covered? Are fees owed on opportunities the athlete finds? What expenses are additional?

Commitment

How long does representation last? Is it exclusive? How can it end? Do any fees continue afterward?

Conflicts

Do you also represent a brand, collective, or another party involved? How are conflicts handled?

Authority

Can you accept terms, sign, or collect money for the athlete? What requires written approval?

Independent review

Who will review the representation agreement independently for the athlete?

Titles vary.

An agent, manager, attorney, and accountant may serve different functions. Confirm the actual scope rather than relying on the title.

04 / Interview record

Keep the answers together

Use a separate copy for each person or firm you interview.

Candidate, firm, contact, and interview date**Services included and excluded; day-to-day contact****Credentials and references checked; where and when verified****Fees, covered income, expenses, and continuing commissions****Term, exclusivity, termination process, and authority granted****Conflicts disclosed; unresolved questions; next step****Decision note**

Can we explain what this person will do, what it costs, and what authority the athlete is giving them?

05

Comparison

Compare the full commitment

Use brief notes in each column. Keep detailed supporting documents with the offer.

Factor	Offer A	Offer B
Cash / noncash value		
Work / time required		
Expenses / fees		
Payment conditions		
Rights / duration		
Exclusivity		
Cancellation questions		
Fit with goals / schedule		
Changes needed		

The athlete's preference and reason

A comparison helps frame a decision. It does not establish market value or legal suitability.

05 / Worked example

The same fee. Different scope.

A hypothetical comparison to help you see what questions to ask.

Proposed term	Offer A	Offer B
Cash compensation	\$750	\$750
Athlete's work	One video	One video
Brand reuse	30 days on brand social accounts	12 months of paid advertising
Category restriction	None stated	Six months
Athlete-paid costs	\$100	\$100
Representative fee	\$75	\$75
Cash before taxes	\$575	\$575

What the arithmetic tells you

Both examples leave the same estimated cash after the listed costs:

$$\$750 - \$100 - \$75 = \$575 \text{ before taxes.}$$

What still needs discussion

Offer B requests a longer advertising period and a restriction on competing partnerships. Ask whether the full scope fits the athlete's goals and whether to discuss changes to rights, compensation, or restrictions.

Compare scope as well as money.

The example does not determine which offer to accept. It shows why the payment alone cannot describe the full commitment.

All figures and terms are illustrative. They are not market rates, fee recommendations, or a valuation. Shaded rows mark the terms that differ.

06

Communication suite

Open the conversation

Adapt the bracketed details. These messages are correspondence, not contract provisions.

01 Request the complete offer

Hello [Name],

Thank you for considering [Athlete]. Please send the proposed agreement, campaign brief, and any attachments or policies referenced in the terms. Please also confirm the deliverables, compensation, usage rights, and response deadline.

Best,
[Name]

02 Request review time

Hello [Name],

Thank you for sending the agreement. We would like until [date] to review it and obtain professional advice before making a decision. Please confirm whether that timeline works for the campaign.

Best,
[Name]

03 Clarify usage

Hello [Name],

Please confirm where [Athlete's] content, name, and image may be used, whether paid advertising is included, when permission ends, and whether editing or sharing with other businesses is permitted. Please reflect the agreed scope in the agreement.

Best,
[Name]

06 / Communication suite

Resolve the details

Keep the exchange clear and save the written response.

04 Clarify payment

Hello [Name],

Please confirm the payment amount, payment trigger, due date, and invoicing requirements. How would completed work and approved expenses be handled if the campaign is canceled?

Thank you,
[Name]

05 Request a change

Hello [Name],

We are interested and would like to discuss [provision]. Our concern is [brief explanation]. Would you consider [specific change]? If we reach agreement, please send an updated version for review.

Best,
[Name]

06 Follow up on payment

Hello [Name],

I'm following up on invoice [number] for [campaign], submitted on [date] and due on [date]. Please confirm its status and expected payment date. I have attached the invoice and delivery confirmation.

Thank you,
[Name]

07 Decline professionally

Hello [Name],

Thank you for considering [Athlete]. After reviewing the opportunity, we have decided to pass on the current terms. We appreciate your time and consideration.

Best,
[Name]

Keep the written record.

Save every reply alongside the offer. If terms change in conversation, ask for the change in writing before you rely on it.

06 / Partnership outreach

Make a specific first pitch

Connect an honest interest in the business with a workable campaign idea.

08 Introduce a partnership idea

Subject: [Athlete] x [Brand] | [Campaign idea]

Hello [Name],

I'm [Athlete], a [sport] athlete whose content focuses on [relevant interests].

I have an idea for [specific campaign concept] that could introduce [product or service] to my audience through [proposed content or appearance].

My recent content averages [accurate metric], and I can share examples relevant to your team. Would you be open to discussing a paid partnership?

Thank you,

[Name and business contact]

Before sending

Use accurate metrics and a business contact address. Choose a concept the athlete can discuss honestly. Confirm applicable requirements before agreeing to perform the campaign.

Our campaign idea and why it fits this business

07

Partnership workflow

Give every stage a next step

Assign responsibility and calendar dates as the opportunity moves forward.

-
- 01 Receive**
Save the offer, verify the business contact, and request complete documents.

 - 02 Evaluate**
Complete the offer, work, compensation, and rights worksheets.

 - 03 Confirm**
Check applicable requirements with school compliance and relevant professionals.

 - 04 Review**
Resolve questions and confirm that negotiated changes appear in the final agreement.

 - 05 Organize**
Keep the signed agreement. Calendar performance, reporting, invoicing, and expiration dates.

 - 06 Deliver**
Follow the agreed scope. Save approvals and evidence of completed work.

 - 07 Collect**
Submit the required invoice, record payment, and follow up when needed.

 - 08 Close**
Keep the campaign record and check for continuing rights or restrictions.

07 / Readiness checkpoints

Confirm what applies

Use current official guidance and advice specific to the athlete.

School and association requirements

Ask the school compliance office which rules, disclosures, and reporting deadlines apply. Discuss uniforms, logos, facilities, existing sponsors, and any restrictions relevant to the opportunity. High school, college, and transfer circumstances may differ.

Sponsored content

The FTC expects material brand connections to be disclosed clearly with an endorsement. Payment and free products can create those connections. Put video disclosures within the video, and use clear language such as “Ad” or “Sponsored.” Endorsements should reflect honest experience. [1]

Compensation records

The NCAA notes that NIL compensation may include money, products, or services, and that NIL income is generally taxable. Keep records and ask a qualified tax professional about the athlete's situation. [2]

Compliance contact, instruction received, and date checked

Reporting or approval steps and confirmed deadlines

Additional professional questions: tax, minor status, or immigration

[1] FTC, [Disclosures 101 for Social Media Influencers](#). [2] NCAA, [Name, Image and Likeness](#). Checked October 3, 2026. Rules change, so check current official guidance before committing.

This kit does not determine eligibility or provide individual tax or immigration advice.

08

Campaign record

Keep the campaign on track

Use one record per partnership and retain supporting documents separately.

Campaign, brand, athlete, and business contact

Current stage and next action; person responsible

Signed agreement and amendments: file location

Deliverables, approval contact, and confirmed deadlines

Reporting or compliance records: location and confirmation

Completed work: publication links, attendance, or other evidence

Rights and exclusivity expiration; closing follow-up

Suggested folders

correspondence

agreement

compliance

content and approvals

delivery evidence

invoices

expenses

08 / Payment record

Track what is due

Keep cash payments, noncash compensation, and expenses clearly identified.

Campaign, paying entity, and payment contact**Invoice number, submission date, and amount****Payment conditions met; supporting evidence sent****Due date, payment received, and remaining balance****Products or services received; date and documented value****Expenses, reimbursements, and receipts****Follow-up history and next action**

Keep account numbers, tax identifiers, and sensitive financial records in appropriately secured storage rather than in this workbook.

09

Decision review

Before accepting

Use the checklist to organize the decision with the athlete and appropriate advisers.

- ☐ The athlete understands and wants the opportunity.
- ☐ We have the complete agreement and referenced documents.
- ☐ The work, deadlines, compensation, and expenses are clear.
- ☐ We understand the proposed usage rights and restrictions.
- ☐ Existing commitments and exclusivity have been checked.
- ☐ Cancellation, repayment, and continuing obligations have been discussed.
- ☐ Signing capacity and any guarantee have been reviewed with counsel as needed.
- ☐ Applicable school and reporting requirements have been confirmed.
- ☐ Questions needing professional advice have been addressed.
- ☐ The final written terms reflect the agreement reached.
- ☐ Someone will track delivery, records, and payment.

Decision: proceed / request changes / decline / obtain more information

Reason and athlete's comments

Completing this checklist does not approve the agreement or replace professional review.

09 / Your next steps

Leave with a clear plan

Identify what still needs to happen, who will handle it, and when.

Priority 1: action, responsible person, and deadline**Priority 2: action, responsible person, and deadline****Priority 3: action, responsible person, and deadline****Questions to bring to a qualified attorney****Need an attorney referral?**

Contact Dexter Sports Management at dextersportsco.com to request a referral.

Dexter Sports Management

Practical NIL education and support for informed conversations about an athlete's opportunities and long-term goals. Dexter Sports Management is a DBA of Dexter Sports Co. LLC.

This toolkit provides general educational guidance and is not legal advice. Consult a qualified attorney about your specific circumstances before signing an agreement. This toolkit does not include representation, individual consulting, or legal services.